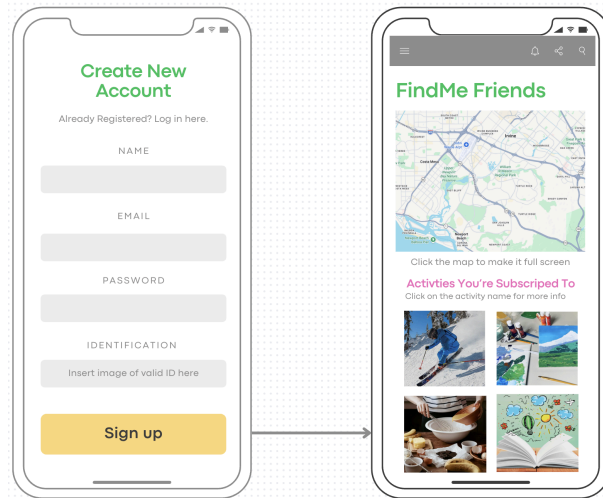
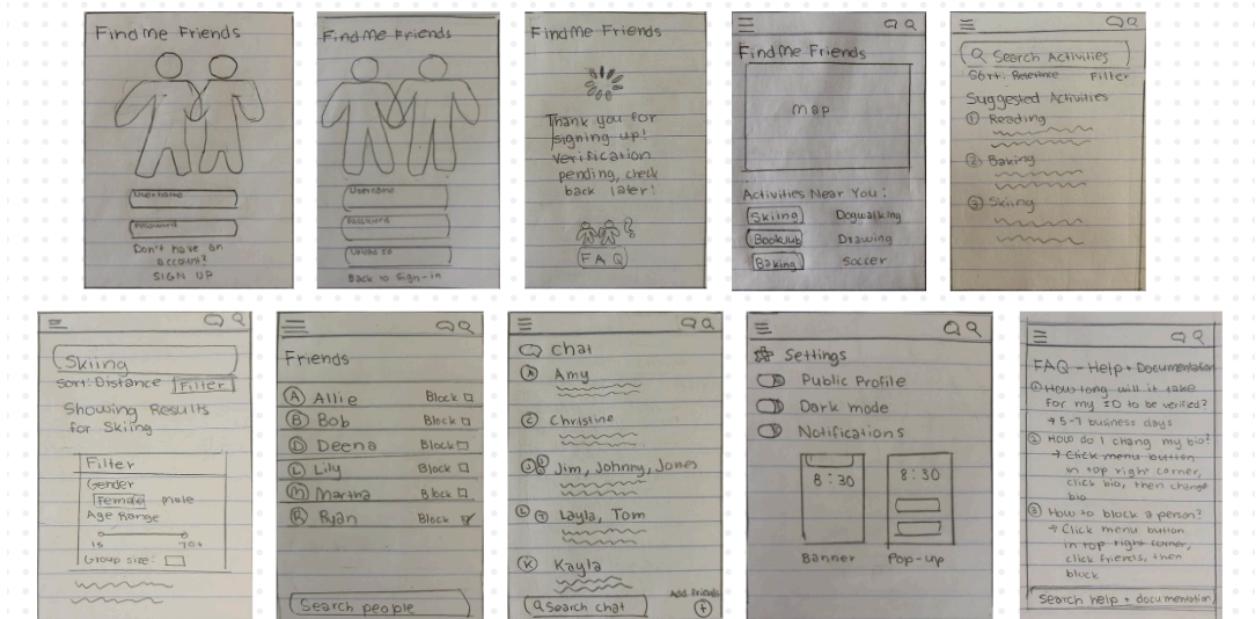


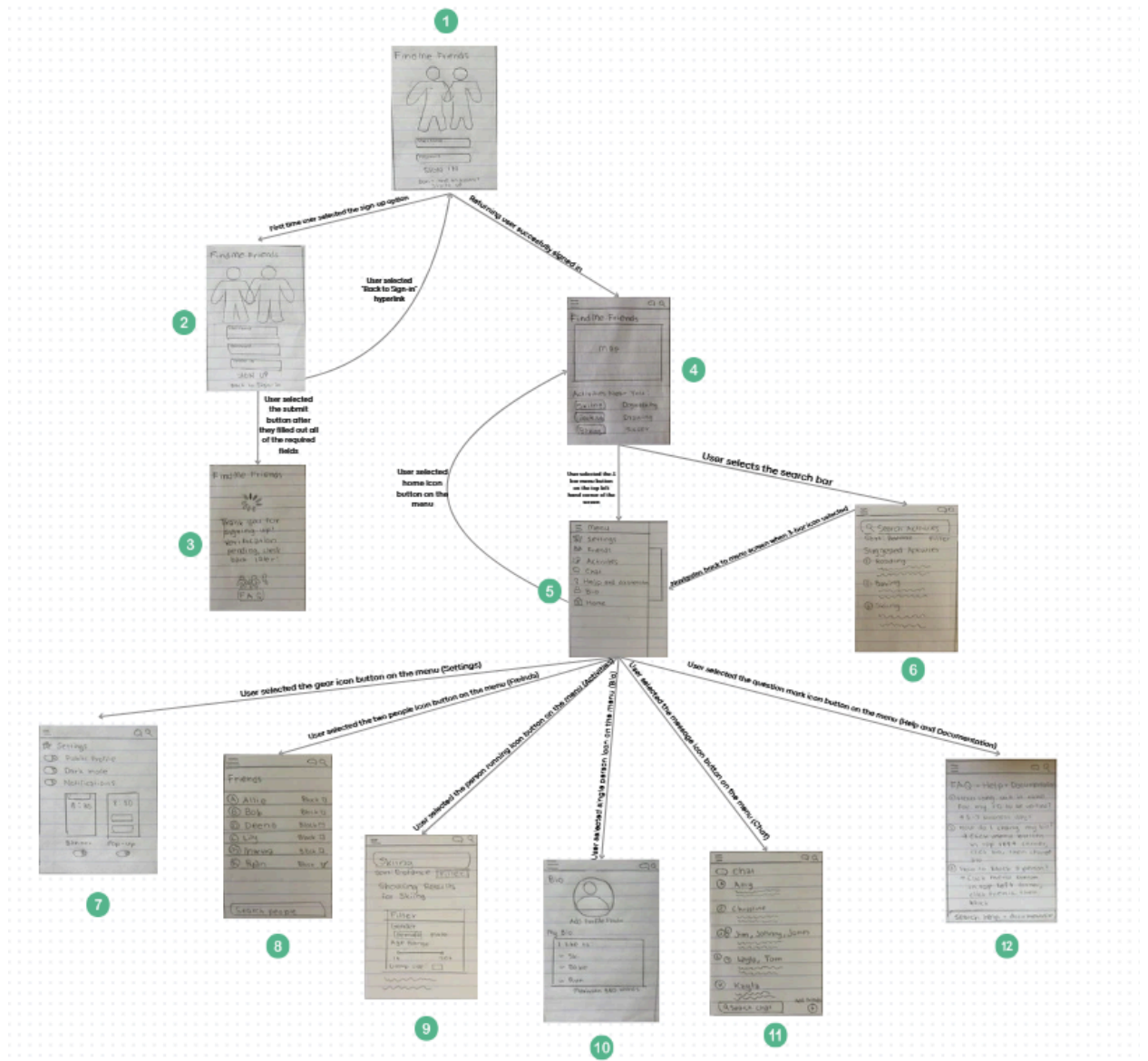
UI Prototype

1. When thinking about the UI portion of our project, we started early. We created a simple mock up on Canva to start visualizing our app. This was our first iteration.



2. Next, we created sketches of each page of the app as a team. This was done on paper.

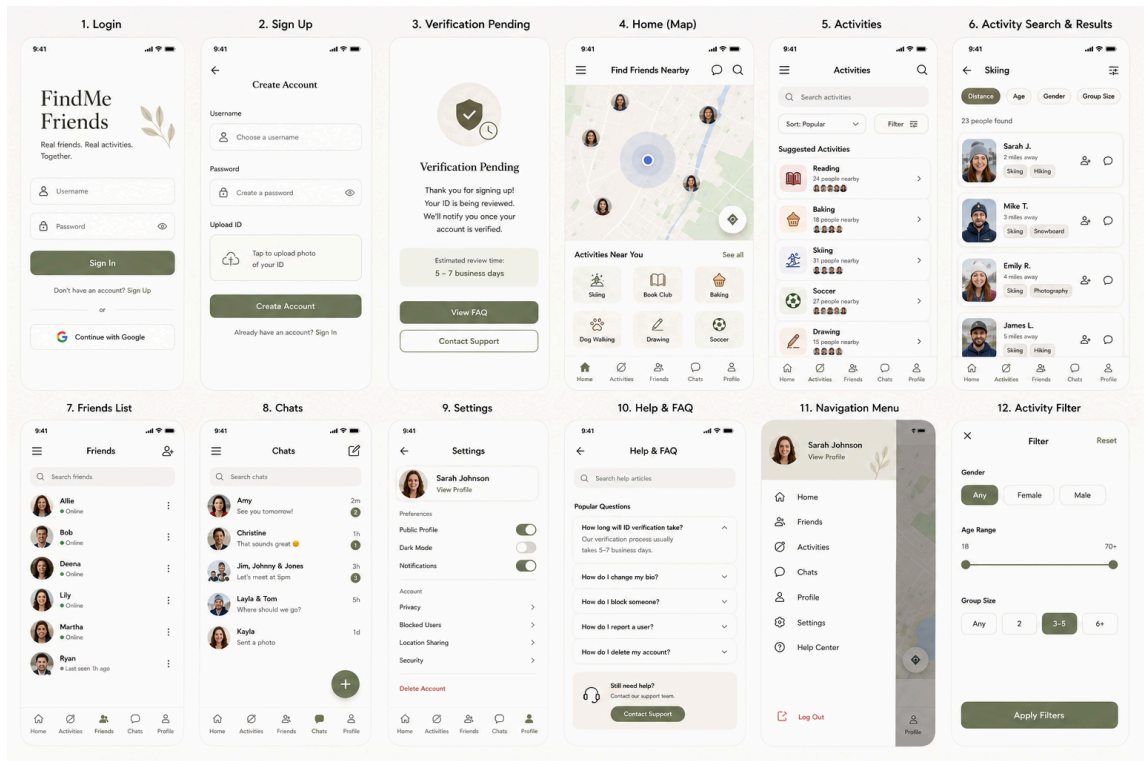




Link for a more clear view: <https://canva.link/tz8ube29i2txflt>

3. Lastly, we prompted ChatGPT plus (we didn't have claude design) by attaching our designs and having the software create a realistic/more fleshed out version of our app. We didn't just let ChatGPT have full creative freedom. In addition to the software following our sketches, we also prompted it to change the color palette and make the app more

minimalist to meet our expectations.



Description of App Elements

For each mockup and screen/activity view, include a description of what the mockup is showing, what each element on the screen represents, and how the user is expected to interact with it. In addition to the mockup drawings we asked Claude to generate other potential buttons or features that could make way for better accessibility and usability for all consumers. Some of their suggestions are implemented in the diagram above.

Each photo has a label on it in the diagram, from 1-12 these descriptions will have their respective numbers that go along with them.

1. Screen name: Sign-in

Description of the mockup:

The mockup shows the app's title at the very top aptly named "Findme Friends". It also displays the Findme Friends logo which is two silhouettes of people holding hands, this logo will also be displayed on the app in the users home screen on their phone. Under the logo there is a text box with placeholder text "Username", indicating to the user that this is where they would enter their username. Additionally, directly under this text box is another text box with placeholder text "Password", indicating to the user that this is where they would enter their password. Under

those text boxes there is a button labeled “SIGN IN”. Under that there is a hyperlink with the following text displayed over it “Don’t have an account? SIGN UP”.

What each element represents:

“Findme Friends” Title: The name of the app

The two people holding hands silhouette: The logo of the Findme Friends app

Username Text box: A text box where users can type in their username using their device’s keyboard

Password Text box: A text box where users can type in their password using their device’s keyboard

The “SIGN IN” button: Represents what the user will click on after they have filled out their respective fields, to sign in.

The text “Don’t have an account? SIGN UP”: A hyperlink that brings the user to a sign up page where they can set up their account information

How the user is expected to interact with it:

Scenario A: An Existing User Logging In

This scenario walks through how a returning user logs into their "Find me Friends" account.

1. Focusing their Input: The user taps on the Username text box. The mobile device's digital keyboard slides up from the bottom of the screen.
2. Entering Credentials: The user types their username. The placeholder text disappears as they type.
3. Moving to Password: The user either taps the "Return" key on their keyboard or taps directly on the Password text box. They type in their password (which should ideally mask the characters with dots or asterisks for privacy).
4. Submitting the Form: The user taps the primary action button labeled “SIGN IN” to authenticate their credentials and enter the app.

Scenario B: A New User Accessing the App

This scenario walks through what happens when a first-time user lands on this screen.

1. Scanning the Page: The user opens the app, realizes they don't have an account yet, and looks past the input fields to the bottom of the screen.
2. Triggering the Navigation: The user taps on the highlighted "Don’t have an account? SIGN UP" hyperlink text.
3. System Response: The current "Sign-in" screen slides away, and the system loads the "Sign-up" screen, prompting them for details like username, password and a government issued ID.

2. Screen name: Sign up

Description of the mockup:

The mockup shows the app's title at the very top aptly named "Findme Friends". It also displays the Findme Friends logo which is two silhouettes of people holding hands, this logo will also be displayed on the app in the users home screen on their phone. Under the logo there is a text box with placeholder text "Username", indicating to the user that this is where they would enter their username that they want for their new account. Additionally, directly under this text box is another text box with placeholder text "Password", indicating to the user that this is where they would enter their password that they want for their new account. Under the password text box is another box labeled "Upload ID", this functions as a button where once clicked on users will be prompted to upload an image of a real government issued ID. Under those text boxes there is a button labeled "SIGN UP". Under that there is a hyperlink with the following text displayed over it "Back to Sign-in", once clicked it will bring them back to the Sign in page.

What each element represents:

"Findme Friends" Title: The name of the app

The two people holding hands silhouette: The logo of the Findme Friends app

Username Text box: A text box where users can type in their created username for their new account using their device's keyboard

Password Text box: A text box where users can type in their created password for their new account using their device's keyboard

The "SIGN UP" button: Represents what the user will click on after they have filled out their respective fields, to sign up.

The text "Back to Sign-in": A hyperlink that brings the user back to the sign-in page where they can sign in to their existing account

How the user is expected to interact with it:

Scenario A: A New User Successfully Registering

This scenario outlines the step-by-step flow for a user creating an account, highlighting the unique interaction required for identity verification.

1. Entering Account Credentials: The user taps the Username field, the keyboard pops up, and they type their desired username.

-They tap the Password field to type their secure password.

2. Triggering the ID Upload: The user taps the "Upload ID" box. Because this requests access to local data, the smartphone system prompts a native permission pop-up: "Findme Friends wants to access your Camera and Photos."

- a. Uploading the Document: The user accepts the permission, choosing either to take a live photo of their government ID using their camera or selecting an existing photo from their gallery.
 - b. Once selected, the screen shows a brief loading spinner within or next to the box, followed by a confirmation message (e.g., a green checkmark or the file name ID_photo.jpg) indicating the upload was successful.
3. Completing Account Creation: The user taps the primary "SIGN UP" button. The app validates that the fields aren't empty, verifies that the username isn't taken, and submits the data to the database for verification.

Scenario B: A Returning User Who Landed Here by Mistake

This scenario covers the alternative navigation path if a user accidentally clicked "Sign Up" from the main login screen.

1. Identifying the Mistake: The user looks at the screen, notices the "Upload ID" requirement, and realizes they already have an active account.
2. Aborting the Process: The user bypasses the input boxes completely and scrolls to the very bottom of the view.
3. Navigating Back: The user taps the "Back to Sign-in" hyperlink. The system immediately destroys the current registration view and slides the original "Sign-in" screen back into focus, preserving the standard back-button behavior expected in mobile applications.

3. Screen name: ID Verification

Description of the mockup:

The mockup shows the app's title at the very top aptly named "Findme Friends". Under the title it also displays a loading circle that has a throbber effect letting users know that the system is currently in a pending/loading state. Under the loading circle there is a display text "Thank you for signing up! Verification pending, check back later!", again informing users that their account verification and validation is still pending. Under the text there is the FindMe Friends logo with two people holding hands placed on top of an "FAQ" (Frequently Asked Questions) button where user are able to click it and it bring them to an FAQ page (Similar to the Help and Documentation screen expect without the menu, chat and search bar options).

What each element represents:

"Findme Friends" Title: The name of the app

Throbber Loading Circle: Represents the systems state as it is processing the users uploaded ID image

Text under the loading circle: A message to the user on the status of the system, informing them that their account verification is still pending and they can check back later

FAQ button: Button for users to use as a reference if they are lost or confused on why after they signed in they can't see their account immediately or other important questions about the app. Once the button is clicked it will bring the user to a FAQ screen page.

How the user is expected to interact with it:

Scenario A: Observing Status and Exiting the App

This scenario outlines the most common path where a user confirms their submission was received and leaves the application to wait.

1. Reading the System Status: Upon completing the sign-up process, the user is automatically redirected to this screen. They observe the Throbber Loading Circle spinning, which visually signals that the app hasn't frozen and is actively processing data.
2. Absorbing the Instructions: The user reads the confirmation text: "Thank you for signing up! Verification pending, check back later!" This sets clear expectations that access is not instantaneous and that no further immediate action is required on this screen.
3. Exiting the Interface: Since there are no input fields or forward navigation buttons, the user taps their device's home button or swipes up to close/minimize the app, intending to reopen it later.

Scenario B: Navigating to the FAQ for Clarification

This scenario covers a user who might feel anxious about safety, data privacy, or the timeline of the verification process.

1. Seeking Information: A user might wonder, "How long will this take?" or "Is my ID safe?" They look past the pending text and spot the FAQ button accompanied by the familiar brand icon at the bottom.
2. Triggering the Navigation: The user taps the "FAQ" button area.
3. System Response: The application opens the FAQ screen view, displaying a list of clean, accordion-style dropdown questions (e.g., "How long does verification take?", "What documents are accepted?").

4. Screen name: Home

Description of the mockup:

The mockup shows a 3 bar icon on the very top left of the screen along with a message icon on the right hand side and next to that a magnifying glass icon button on the very top right. Under

these icons there is the app's name "Findme Friends" displayed in text. Then under that text there is a box covering about 40% of the screen labeled map. Under that box there is text "Activities Near You:". Below that there are 6 unique buttons each with different names displayed on them, the first row has "Skiing" on the left side and "Dogwalking" on the right side. Then the second row on the left side is "Bookclub" and the right side is "Drawing", the last row towards the bottom of the screen is "Baking" on the left side and "Soccer" on the right side.

What each element represents:

3-bar icon: This is the menu button where users are able to click on it and a menu screen will pop up.

Message icon: This is the chat shortcut, once clicked on it will navigate users over to the chat screen.

Magnifying glass: This is the search bar button, once clicked on it will navigate users over to the search screen.

"Findme Friends" Title: The name of the app

The box labeled map: This is where the live updated map will be displayed showing the users current position and current activities happening near the user on the map given the users current set radius.

The buttons under activities near you: They each represent the 6 most popular activities. They function as shortcuts and once clicked on it will bring the user to the activities page where they are able to search for the activity they just clicked on given their constraints in their filter.

How the user is expected to interact with it:

Scenario A: Exploring Nearby Activities via the Map & Shortcuts

This scenario covers the primary user journey: a user looking for something fun to do in their local area right now.

1. Orienting on the Map: When the app opens to this screen, the user looks at the Map View. The map automatically centers on their current GPS location (represented by a blue dot) and displays small, clickable pins showing active meetups/activities nearby.
2. Interacting with the Map: The user can use standard touch gestures:
 - a. Drag/Swipe: To pan across the map and see activities a few miles away.
 - b. Pinch-to-Zoom: To look closer at a specific neighborhood block.
3. Using Quick Category Shortcuts: If the user doesn't want to browse blindly, they look at the "Activities Near You" section. They see a category they like, for example, "Dogwalking" and tap on it.

4. System Response: The app filters the map to only show dog-walking groups or navigates the user directly to a list view of local dog-walking events happening today.

Scenario B: Accessing Secondary App Features (Navigation)

This scenario covers how a user navigates away from the main dashboard to check their messages or update their profile settings.

1. Checking Direct Messages: The user notices a small red notification badge on the Message Icon in the top right. They tap the icon, and the app transitions to their active chat list to talk to friends they've made.
2. Using the Global Search: The user wants to find a specific activity not listed in the shortcuts. They tap the Magnifying Glass, which opens a text search bar with their keyboard.
3. Opening the Sidebar Menu: The user wants to change their account settings or log out. They tap the 3-bar (Hamburger) Icon in the top left. A menu drawer slides out from the left side of the screen, revealing options like Profile, Settings, and a variety of other options.

5. Screen name: Menu

Description of the mockup:

The mockup shows a 3 bar icon on the very top left of the screen along with the text “Menu” on the right of it. Under that there is a gear icon accompanied by “Settings” text. Under that there is an icon of two people silhouettes next to each other accompanied by “Friends” text. Under that in the row under it there is a person running icon that is accompanied by “Activities” text. Under that in the row under it there is a message icon that is accompanied by “Chat” text. Under that in the row under it there is a question mark icon that is accompanied by “Help and Documentation” text. Under that in the row under it there is a person icon that is accompanied by “Bio” text. Under that in the row under it there is a house icon that is accompanied by “Home” text.

What each element represents:

3-bar icon: This is the menu button where users are able to click on it and a menu screen will pop up. Alternatively, when the menu screen is open then it can be clicked again to close the menu screen and return to the previous page. The menu text is not interactable it helps the user know what screen they are on.

The gear icon: This is a button that when clicked on it will navigate the user to the settings screen, the “Settings” text helps the user know that the gear means settings.

The two people icon: This is a button that when clicked on it will navigate the user to the Friends screen, the “Friends” text helps the user know that the two people mean friends.

The running person icon: This is a button that when clicked on it will navigate the user to the activities screen, the “Activities” text helps the user know that the running person means activities.

The message icon: This is a button that when clicked on it will navigate the user to the chat screen, the “Chat” text helps the user know that the message icon means chat. It also helps the user know that since this is a reused icon it will navigate to the same place.

The question mark icon: This is a button that when clicked on it will navigate the user to the Help and Documentation screen, the “Help and Documentation” text helps the user know that the question mark means Help and Documentation.

The person icon: This is a button that when clicked on it will navigate the user to the bio screen, the “Bio” text helps the user know that the person icon means bio.

The home icon: This is a button that when clicked on it will navigate the user to the home screen, the “Home” text helps the user know that the home icon means Home screen.

How the user is expected to interact with it:

Scenario A: Navigating to a Target Screen

This scenario outlines the standard path for a user looking to hop from the map view to another area of the app, like updating their bio.

1. Opening the Drawer: From the main dashboard, the user taps the top-left hamburger icon. The menu drawer smoothly slides out from the left edge, partially covering the active screen with a darkened translucent overlay (scrim) over the remaining area on the right.
2. Scanning and Recognition: The user runs their eyes vertically down the clean list of options. They quickly find what they need thanks to the visual anchors (the icons) paired with the clear text strings.
3. Triggering the Route: The user taps on the row containing the person icon and the text "Bio".
4. System Response: The menu row provides instant haptic or visual feedback (e.g., a brief highlight flash), the navigation drawer slides back out of view, and the screen seamlessly transitions to the user's personal Bio editing profile page.

Scenario B: Dismissing the Menu (User Control and Freedom)

This scenario covers what happens if a user opens the menu by accident or changes their mind and wants to stay on the page they were already looking at.

1. Canceling the Action: The user opens the menu, realizes they don't want to leave the current screen, and wants to close the drawer.

2. Executing the Exit: The user is provided two natural ways to do this:
 - a. Option 1: They tap the 3-bar icon at the top left again.
 - b. Option 2: They tap anywhere on the exposed slice of the previous screen on the right side (the area outside the solid drawer boundaries).
3. System Response: The system recognizes the abort intent, slides the drawer back to the left, clears the darkened background overlay, and returns full focus to the underlying screen without making any changes.

6. Screen name: Activity Search Menu Bar Example

Description of the mockup:

The mockup shows a 3 bar icon on the very top left of the screen along with a message icon on the right hand side and next to that a gear icon button on the very top right. Under that there is a search activities feature. The user can click on it and their keyboard will appear so they can type in a keyword to search for. Then they can sort and filter, which is further explained in number nine. Underneath that, it shows suggested activities. These suggestions will pop up when the user does not search for a keyword. If they do, then the results will adapt to that key word. What this mockup is trying to show is that when a user is on another page and wants to return to the home screen, they will click the 3 bar icon. After clicking the three bar icon they can click home, which will take them to the landing page. The landing page is described in number two of this list.

What each element represents:

3-bar icon: This is the menu button where users are able to click on it and a menu screen will pop up.

Message icon: This is the chat shortcut, once clicked on it will navigate users over to the chat screen.

Magnifying glass: This is the search bar button, once clicked on it will navigate users over to the search screen.

Sort: The user can sort by distance, relevance, and group capacity by picking their option from a drop down menu.

Filter: The user clicks this and a pop up appears. They can choose gender, age range, and group size. To go back to search results, they click the filter button again.

Suggested Activities: A user can click on a list item in the results to learn more about the activity.

How the user is expected to interact with it:

Scenario A: Going back to home

1. User searches an activity

2. The user decides that they want to go back to the home screen
3. The user clicks the menu button
4. From the menu, they click home
5. They are redirected to the home screen, which includes the map and activities near you

Scenario B: Searching for an Activity

1. User searches an activity
2. User decides to sort by distance
3. User decides to filter by female
4. Suggested results pop up based on the users preferences

7. Screen name: Settings

Description of the mockup:

The mockup shows a 3 bar icon on the very top left of the screen along with a message icon on the right hand side and next to that a gear icon button on the very top right. Under the icons above it shows the following title text “Settings”. Under the title there are toggleable options the user can choose to activate or deactivate, the first one towards the top of the page under the “Settings” title is “Public Profile”, the one underneath that is “Dark Mode”, then the one after that is "Notifications". Under the notifications toggle, there are two images of a screen displaying both ways notifications could be displayed on their phone. The first way is the “Banner” method where the notification would come from the top and notify users at the top of their device. The second option is the Pop-up option where it displays a device receiving notifications from the bottom up where they pop up from the bottom of the screen. Under these two options are toggles where the user is able to select which method they want for their notifications.

What each element represents:

3-bar icon: This is the menu button where users are able to click on it and a menu screen will pop up.

Message icon: This is the chat shortcut, once clicked on it will navigate users over to the chat screen.

Magnifying glass: This is the search bar button, once clicked on it will navigate users over to the search screen.

The title “Setting” and gear icon: These represent the title of the screen and are a way to indicate to the user what page they are currently on.

The “Public Profile” toggle: Currently the toggle is off as the white circle is towards the left of the screen, meaning that the user's profile is private meaning that it is hidden towards other people that are not their friends.

The “Dark mode” toggle: Currently the screen is showing that the toggle is off, meaning that the phone is in light mode but when turned on dark mode will activate adjusting the apps brightness and color palette to fit the dark theme.

The "Notifications" toggle: Currently the screen is showing that the toggle is turned off, meaning that the user deactivated notifications so they wouldn't receive any from the app. When activated this allows users to receive notifications from the app.

The two images showing the different versions of notifications: These represent the options the user can select for the way they receive notifications, these are only selectable via the toggles underneath them only if notifications are turned on otherwise they do nothing when selected.

Also the toggles can have one on and the other off at all times they never can be turned on the same time.

How the user is expected to interact with it:

Scenario A: Adjusting Privacy and App Appearance

This scenario walks through how a user interacts with the basic boolean (on/off) switches to instantly change their app experience.

1. Changing Privacy Settings: The user wants to make their account discoverable to local users. They tap the toggle switch next to "Public Profile". The switch smoothly slides from left to right, changing from an unshaded indicator to a fully colored active state. The backend instantly updates their profile visibility status.
2. Switching to Dark Mode: Feeling the strain of light mode, the user taps the toggle next to "Dark Mode". The switch slides to the right. Instantly, the app triggers a stylesheet change flipping the bright white background to deep gray/black and changing the dark text to white providing immediate visual confirmation.

Scenario B: Configuring Notification Preferences (Conditional Logic)

This scenario covers a slightly more complex interaction path that involves dependent UI elements.

1. Enabling Notifications: Initially, the user observes that the main "Notifications" toggle is turned off. Because it is off, the "Banner" and "Pop-up" selection controls below it are visually faded or grayed out in a disabled state.
2. Activating the Sub-menu: The user taps the primary "Notifications" toggle. As it slides to the active position, the system dynamically activates the selection elements underneath, brightening them to show they can now be interacted with.

3. Choosing a Visual Style: The user evaluates the two phone graphics to see how alerts will look. Preferring alerts to arrive unobtrusively from the top, they tap the circle container underneath the "Banner" graphic.
4. System Feedback: The selection circle under "Banner" fills in with a toggle color indicating active, while the toggle under "Pop-up" remains deactivated, ensuring a mutually exclusive choice.

8. Screen name: Friends

Description of the mockup:

The mockup shows a 3 bar icon on the very top left of the screen along with a message icon on the right hand side and next to that a magnifying glass icon button on the very top right. Under the icons above it shows the following title text "Friends". Under the title, there are 6 rows each containing the icon for the friend, the friend's name, and the block button on the very right of the row. The first row contains the letter "A" icon in a circle since that is the first letter that the friends name starts with, the friends name is "Allie", on the very right of "Allie" is the text "Block" accompanied by a check box to the right of it. The second row contains the letter "B" icon in a circle since that is the first letter that the friends name starts with, the friends name is "Bob", on the very right of "Bob" is the text "Block" accompanied by a check box to the right of it. Similarly you have the same format for the next row with "Deena", and the row after that "Lily", the row after that "Martha", up until this point all the block checkboxes were unchecked. When we look at the row containing the name "Ryan" we see that the Block checkbox has a check through it. Under all the rows to the very bottom of the screen we can see a box with placeholder text in it "Search people".

What each element represents:

3-bar icon: This is the menu button where users are able to click on it and a menu screen will pop up.

Message icon: This is the chat shortcut, once clicked on it will navigate users over to the chat screen.

Magnifying glass: This is the search bar button, once clicked on it will navigate users over to the search screen.

The title "Friends": This is the title of the screen assisting users know which page they are currently on.

The circles that include the first letter of the friend's name: These represent a quick way of identifying the friend via a mini icon and it becomes normal for the app and the user since these icons are also used for their chats with their friends indicating who is in the group chat.

The names of the friends: These represent the actual name of the friend presented in text in the row that that friend corresponds to.

The Block checkbox: This represents the status and the way to block the friend. If the user wants to block the friend then they would go to their row and they would click on that checkbox then they would see a check. The user can view the status of their block by confirmation that they see a check mark on the block checkbox on that friend's name.

The box with placeholder text "Search people": This represents the place where users can type in a friend's name they are looking for and the closest or matching result will populate where the rows currently are.

How the user is expected to interact with it:

Scenario A: Scrolling the List and Managing Friend Status (Blocking)

This scenario walks through how a user reviews their active connections and alters a relationship status directly from the interface rows.

1. Browsing the List: The user enters the screen and views an alphabetical list of their connections. They easily identify individuals using the standardized letter-avatar circles (e.g., the circle with an "A" for Allie).
2. Identifying a Blocked User: The user scrolls down to the row for "Ryan". They observe a visual checkmark inside the checkbox next to the word "Block." This provides clear, immediate feedback that Ryan's account is currently restricted from contacting them.
3. Blocking a New User: The user decides they want to restrict "Allie". They tap directly on the empty checkbox at the right end of Allie's row.
4. System Response: The checkbox instantly fills with a checkmark. Behind the scenes, the app updates Allie's permission status, automatically restricting her from seeing the user on the map or sending them direct messages.

Scenario B: Filtering Connections via the Search Bar

This scenario covers how a user navigates a long friend list efficiently without endless vertical scrolling, hitting Nielsen's heuristic of Accelerators which is Flexibility and efficiency of use.

1. Activating the Search Input: The user taps inside the long rectangular box at the bottom of the screen labeled with the placeholder text "Search people".
2. Typing a Query: The device's native keyboard slides up. The user begins typing a name, for example, "Ma".

3. **Dynamic Filtering:** As the user types, the main list dynamically updates in real-time. Rows for "Allie," "Bob," "Deena," and "Lily" immediately disappear from view, leaving only "Martha" displayed on the screen because her name matches the typed characters.
4. **Clearing the Filter:** To view the full list again, the user either hits a small "X" in the text box or deletes their text using the backspace key, prompting the system to repopulate all 6 original rows.

9. Screen name: Activities

Description of the mockup:

The mockup shows a 3 bar icon on the very top left of the screen along with a message icon on the right hand side and next to that a magnifying glass icon button on the very top right. Under these icons there is the activity search bar. This is where a user can search activities they are interested in or are looking to be a part of. Underneath the search bar there are two options. The first option is to sort the results. The sort options include: distance, relevance, and group capacity. Next to the sort feature there is a filter feature. When you click on it, a pop up will show up containing filter options. These filter options include gender, age range, and group size. For gender, the user can click a button to indicate what gender. If the user does not want to filter by gender they do not have to select either option. For the age range, there is a sliding bar where the user can indicate the age range they prefer. For group size, the user can enter a number and it will show activities of groups with similar size.

What each element represents:

3-bar icon: This is the menu button where users are able to click on it and a menu screen will pop up.

Message icon: This is the chat shortcut, once clicked on it will navigate users over to the chat screen.

Magnifying glass: This is the search bar button, once clicked on it will navigate users over to the search screen.

The title "Showing Results for skiing": This is the title of the search results to show the user what activity category they are looking at.

Sort: The user can sort by distance, relevance, and group capacity by picking their option from a drop down menu.

Filter: The user clicks this and a pop up appears. They can choose gender, age range, and group size. To go back to search results, they click the filter button again.

How the user is expected to interact with it:

The user is expected to interact with it by searching for an activity, and then choosing their filter and sort options.

Scenario A: Searching for an activity with a filter

1. The user searches a keyword
2. The user click the filter button
3. A pop up appears with filter options
4. The user filters by gender and group size
5. The user clicks the filter button again to apply filter options
6. The new filtered results appear

Scenario B: Searching for an activity with sort

1. The user searches a keyword
2. The user click the sort button
3. A drop down menu appears with distance, relevance, and group capacity options.
4. The user sorts by group capacity from low to high
5. The new results appear

10. Screen name: Bio

Description of the mockup:

The mockup shows a 3 bar icon on the very top left of the screen along with a message icon on the right hand side and next to that a magnifying glass icon button on the very top right. Under the icons above it shows the following title text “Bio”. Underneath the title there is a circle with an image of the bio icon. This indicates that they have not added a profile picture yet.

Underneath that, there is an option to add a profile picture. The user will click the add profile picture text and will be prompted to attach a photo of their choosing. They will be able to zoom in and crop the picture to their liking. Underneath the profile picture section there is a “my bio” section. Here, a user can write about themselves, what they like to do, etc. The maximum word count is 350 words. The reason for this is to ensure that the bios aren’t overly long. Since 350 words may not fit fully on a phone screen, the user will be able to scroll down to see the rest of the bio.

What each element represents:

3-bar icon: This is the menu button where users are able to click on it and a menu screen will pop up.

Message icon: This is the chat shortcut, once clicked on it will navigate users over to the chat screen.

Magnifying glass: This is the search bar button, once clicked on it will navigate users over to the search screen.

The title “Bio”: This is the title of the screen assisting users know which page they are currently on.

Profile picture: A user can select a profile picture or keep the default.

Bio: A user can write a bio, or can keep it blank.

How the user is expected to interact with it:

Scenario A: Change Profile Picture

1. The user wants to change their profile picture
2. They click on the add profile picture button
3. A pop up appears where they can upload a picture of their choosing
4. Then that picture will appear in the circle and they are able to crop and adjust it
5. They click done, and then their new profile picture appears

Scenario B: Add to Bio

1. The user wants to add to their bio
2. They click on the textbox and their keyboard appears
3. They type their bio and then click out of the textbox for it to save

11. Screen name: Chat

Description of the mockup:

The mockup shows a 3 bar icon on the very top left of the screen along with a message icon on the right hand side and next to that a magnifying glass icon button on the very top right. Under the icons above it shows the following title text “Chat”. Underneath that there is a list of chats. We chose to follow a similar style to text message, because users will recognize/be used to using it already. For each chat, there is a circle with a letter in it. This represents the first letter of the name the user is chatting with. If they have a profile picture, that will be used instead. There is also a group chat feature that works the same as an individual chat, just with more people. At the very bottom of the users screen, there is a search chat feature. A user can search a key word and it will search through all their old chats and show relevant results. In the bottom right corner, they can add more friends to chat with. They do this by clicking the plus and then searching for their friend to add.

3-bar icon: This is the menu button where users are able to click on it and a menu screen will pop up.

Message icon: This is the chat shortcut, once clicked on it will navigate users over to the chat screen.

Magnifying glass: This is the search bar button, once clicked on it will navigate users over to the search screen.

The title “Chat”: This is the title of the screen assisting users know which page they are currently on.

The circles that include the first letter of the friend's name: These represent a quick way of identifying the friend via a mini icon and it becomes normal for the app and the user since these icons are also used for their chats with their friends indicating who is in the group chat.

The names of the friends: These represent the actual name of the friend presented in text in the row that that friend corresponds to.

Search bar: The user can search chat with keywords, and will be presented with relevant results.
Plus sign: Next to the search bar, the user can click on it to add more friends to chat with.

How the user is expected to interact with it:

Scenario A: Clicking into a chat

1. The user wants to click into a chat
2. They click on the row of the chat they want to enter
3. They are redirected to a new page and are now in chat
4. They are able to type and interact with message
5. To leave the chat they would click the back button

Scenario B: Adding a new chat

1. The user wants to add a new chat
2. They click on the plus sign icon
3. They are then able to search through their friends via scrolling or a search bar to find the friend they want to chat with
4. They click the friend and they are redirected to a new chat
5. They can type out their chat and send it off
6. Their friend will receive it
7. This chat will now appear in their current chat list

12. Screen name: Help and Documentation

Description of the mockup:

The mockup shows a 3 bar icon on the very top left of the screen along with a message icon on the right hand side and next to that a magnifying glass icon button on the very top right. Under the icons above it shows the following title text “FAQ - Help and Documentation”. Under the title it displays a number one circle and next to that circle is the following question in the form of text “How long will it take for my ID to be verified?”, under that question there is an arrow pointing to the answer of that question which is also in the form of text “-> 5-7 business days”. Under the first question and answer it displays a number two circle and next to that circle is the following question in the form of text “How do I change my bio?”, under that question there is an arrow pointing to the answer of that question which is also in the form of text “-> Click menu button in the top left corner, click bio, then change bio”. Under the second question it displays a number three circle and next to that circle is the following question in the form of text “How to block a person?”, under that question there is an arrow pointing to the answer of that question which is also in the form of text “-> Click menu button in top left corner, click friends, then block”. Under the last third question there is a box with placeholder text reading “Search help + documentation”.

What each element represents:

3-bar icon: This is the menu button where users are able to click on it and a menu screen will pop up.

Message icon: This is the chat shortcut, once clicked on it will navigate users over to the chat screen.

Magnifying glass: This is the search bar button, once clicked on it will navigate users over to the search screen.

The title “FAQ - Help and Documentation”: This is the title of the screen assisting users know which page they are currently on.

The three questions along with their answers: These represent the FAQs and they serve as a reference for users struggling with similar issues or have similar questions.

The box at the very bottom with placeholder text “Search help + documentation”: This represents the search bar that users are able to use to look up any specific information on the FAQ page.

How the user is expected to interact with it:

Scenario A: Browsing Frequently Asked Questions

This scenario covers the primary path where a user easily finds the answer to a common issue just by scanning the page.

1. Scanning the Content: The user arrives on the page and reads the main title to confirm they are in the right place. They scan the numbered list of the most common questions.
2. Finding the Answer: The user wonders how long their ID will take to process. They read question #1 and immediately see the nested answer indicated by the arrow: "5-7 business days." No extra taps are required since the text is fully displayed.
3. Following Instructions: If the user wants to change their bio, they read question #2, note the step-by-step directions, and then tap the 3-bar menu icon in the top left to execute those steps immediately without having to guess the navigation path.

Scenario B: Searching for Specific Help

This scenario outlines what happens when a user's problem is more niche and isn't covered by the top three default questions.

1. Locating the Search Input: The user has a specific question (for example, "How do I delete my account?") that isn't listed. They look at the bottom of the screen and tap the box labeled "Search help + documentation".
2. Entering the Query: The mobile device's keyboard slides up. The user types in their keywords.

3. System Response: Depending on the implementation, the screen either dynamically filters a longer list of hidden help articles as they type, or the user taps "Search/Enter" on their keyboard to load a dedicated results page containing articles matching their query.

Heuristic Evaluation

For each of the Nielsen heuristics, describe how your user interface / user experience addresses that aspect. Please note that you may not be able to fully implement all of these UI features by the end of the quarter, but we want to see how you are thinking about these aspects, and what your intentions would be.

1. Visibility of system status
 - a. How the UI addresses it: The ID Verification screen is dedicated entirely to this heuristic. By using a visual loading circle alongside the text "Verification pending, check back later!", the user is never left wondering if their sign-up failed.
 - b. Future Intentions: When implementing the live app, turning on a setting (like Dark Mode) will give immediate visual feedback by changing the color theme instantly, and tapping the Block checkbox will immediately fill it with a checkmark so status changes are obvious.
2. Match system words to the real world
 - a. How the UI addresses it: The app completely avoids confusing technical words. The dashboard uses human, real-world hobbies for its filters like "Dogwalking," "Baking," and "Soccer." Additionally, the menu icons rely on commonly used icons: a gear for Settings, a house for Home, and a magnifying glass for Search.
3. User control and freedom
 - a. How the UI addresses it: Users are provided clear "emergency exits" throughout the navigation flow. A new user who accidentally lands on the registration page can tap "Back to Sign-in" to reverse their action. Similarly, the Menu drawer can be closed either by tapping the 3-bar icon again or by tapping outside the drawer boundaries.
 - b. Future Intentions: On the Friends screen, if a user accidentally blocks someone, they have the freedom to immediately undo it by tapping the checkbox again to uncheck it and they see the status reflected.
4. Consistency and standards
 - a. How the UI addresses it: The application enforces a strict global header standard. The main dashboard, Settings, Friends list, and FAQ screens all feature the exact same top navigation layout: a 3-bar menu on the far left, with chat and search icons grouped on the far right. This ensures users don't have to relearn layout rules from page to page, as it is consistent throughout.
5. Error prevention

- a. How the UI addresses it: The Sign-in and Sign-up screens use explicit placeholder text inside the input fields ("Username", "Password") to ensure users understand exactly what data is expected before they attempt to submit.
 - b. Future Intentions: Because clicking "Block" on the Friends screen is a severe action, we intend to implement a confirmation pop-up modal asking, "Are you sure you want to block this user?" to prevent accidental finger slips while scrolling.
- 6. Recognition rather than recall
 - a. How the UI addresses it: The Menu drawer lists both the feature icon and the descriptive text label side-by-side (e.g., the person icon next to the word "Bio"). This removes cognitive load, the user recognizes the action immediately instead of having to memorize what an abstract icon stands for.
 - b. Future Intentions: The letter-avatars (like the "A" circle for Allie) will be used consistently across both the Friends list and the Chat windows so users instantly recognize their contacts visually.
- 7. Accelerators
 - a. How the UI addresses it: The core map dashboard features 6 unique activity shortcut buttons ("Skiing", "Drawing", etc.). This serves as an accelerator for experienced users, letting them bypass deep custom search filters and hop straight to popular local meetups with a single tap.
 - b. Future Intentions: The search bar on the Friends and FAQ screens will feature auto-complete filtering, letting users type just 2 or 3 letters to find exactly what they need instantly.
- 8. Minimalist design
 - a. How the UI addresses it: The screens are highly focused and omit irrelevant information. The ID Verification screen intentionally hides the noisy search/chat headers and maps, showing only the vital loading status and a direct pathway to help. The home view dedicates its space cleanly between a geographic overview and direct category buttons.
- 9. Help users recognize and recover from errors
 - a. How the UI addresses it: While the current low-fidelity sketches focus on success states, our framework accounts for handling mistakes gracefully.
 - b. Future Intentions: If a user types an incorrect password on the Sign-in screen, the app will not show a cryptic error code. Instead, the password box text border will turn red, and a plain-English message will appear directly below it saying:
"Incorrect password. Please try again or reset your password."
- 10. Help and documentation
 - a. How the UI addresses it: The system includes a dedicated "FAQ - Help and Documentation" screen. It features straightforward, numbered instructions detailing how to solve the most critical user issues, such as account setup wait

times ("5-7 business days") and actionable guides on how to block users or change a bio.